

Recycling & Waste Segregation Guidelines (India — General Municipal Framework)

Note: Waste rules vary by city/municipal corporation (e.g., BBMP for Bengaluru, MCGM for Mumbai, MCD for Delhi). This document gives the common framework most Indian municipalities follow under the Solid Waste Management Rules. Replace or supplement with your target city's official corporation guidelines for accuracy in a real deployment.

The Three-Bin System

Most Indian municipalities require households to segregate waste into at least three categories:

1. **Wet / Biodegradable Waste (Green bin)**
 - Kitchen scraps, vegetable and fruit peels, food leftovers, tea/coffee grounds, garden waste, flowers.
 - Should NOT include plastic liners, diapers, or sanitary waste.
2. **Dry / Recyclable Waste (Blue bin)**
 - Paper, cardboard, clean plastic packaging, glass bottles, metal cans, tetra packs.
 - Rinse containers before disposal — food residue can contaminate an entire batch and make it non-recyclable.
3. **Reject / Hazardous Waste (Black or red bin, varies by city)**
 - Sanitary waste, diapers, medical waste, batteries, e-waste, broken glass, multi-layered plastic sachets.
 - Sanitary and medical waste should typically be wrapped separately and clearly marked before disposal.

E-Waste

- Electronics (phones, chargers, batteries, small appliances) should never go into regular household waste.
- Most cities have authorized e-waste collection centers or periodic collection drives run by the municipal corporation or certified recyclers.
- Many electronics retailers also run take-back or exchange programs for old devices.

Composting

- Wet waste can be composted at home using a compost bin, pit, or vermicomposting setup, reducing what needs to be collected.
- Several Residents' Welfare Associations (RWAs) and apartment complexes run community composting programs — check with your building management.

What Often Cannot Be Recycled Through Standard Municipal Systems

- Multi-layered plastic (chip packets, shampoo sachets)
- Thermocol/styrofoam

- Contaminated or food-soiled paper and cardboard
- Broken ceramics and mirrors (these usually go in reject waste, not glass recycling)

Bulk & Special Waste

- Construction and demolition debris typically requires separate disposal arrangements with the municipal corporation, not regular household collection.
- Large appliances and furniture usually need a special pickup request rather than curbside disposal.

Practical Tip for Users

Encourage checking the specific municipal corporation's app or website (most major Indian cities now have one) for exact collection days, bin color codes, and drop-off center locations, since these details differ by city and change periodically.